iLearn Practice Exam

12BR · Chapter / Topic 13

Cambridge A Level Computer Science 9618

Paper 3 Advanced Theory

Topic 13: Data Representation

Name: _____

Class: _____

Date: _____

Time allowed: 1 hour 30 minutes

TOTAL MARKS: 72

Marks obtained: ..... / 72

INSTRUCTIONS

· Answer all questions.
· Write your answers in the spaces provided on this paper, using a black or dark blue pen.
· Do not use an erasable pen or correction fluid.
· No calculators are allowed.
· Do not write anything in the margins.

INFORMATION

· The total mark for this paper is 72.
· The number of marks for each question or part question is shown in brackets [ ].
· This paper contains 12 questions, all drawn from Cambridge past papers on this chapter.
· After you finish, mark your work against the official Cambridge mark scheme (see the source list on the last page).

Questions reproduced from Cambridge International past papers © Cambridge University Press & Assessment, for classroom practice.

1 A programmer is writing a program to manage bookings for a small taxi company. The programmer requires some user-defined data types.

(a) Write a **pseudocode** statement to declare the enumerated data type, `Vehicle`, to hold the identity code of each of the company's taxis:

M100, M230, T101, T102, T120, T150

.....

..... [2]

(b) Write **pseudocode** statements to declare the composite data type, `Booking`, to hold data about taxi bookings. The data required includes:

- booking number (any combination of letters and numbers)
- destination
- client name
- client telephone number
- date of departure
- address for pick-up
- the identity code of the taxi used.

Use the most appropriate data type in each case, including the enumerated data type from part **(a)**.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... [4]

2 Numbers are stored in a computer using binary floating-point representation with:

- 10 bits for the mantissa
- 6 bits for the exponent
- two's complement form for both the mantissa and the exponent.

(a) Write the normalised floating-point representation of the following binary number using this system.

0.00000011010111

Mantissa **Exponent**

[2]

(b) Calculate the normalised binary floating-point representation of –25.3125 in this system. Show your working.

Mantissa **Exponent**

Working .....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

[4]

3 **(a)** User-defined data types may be created by programmers when writing software.

Explain the reasons why user-defined data types are needed.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... [3]

(b) Write the pseudocode statement to declare a non-composite data type, `Fibonacci`, that holds the following numbers:

0, 1, 2, 3, 5, 8, 13, 21

.....

.....

.....

..... [2]

4 **(a)** State **one** example of where serial file organisation could be used.

.....

..... [1]

(b) Describe how records are organised in serial files.

.....

.....

.....

..... [2]

(c) Outline the process that is used to find a record in a serial file.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... [3]

5 Numbers are stored in a computer system using binary floating-point representation with:

- 12 bits for the mantissa
- 4 bits for the exponent
- two's complement form for both the mantissa and the exponent.

(a) Calculate the normalised binary floating-point representation of –18.5625 in this system.

Show your working.

mantissa **exponent**

working .....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

[4]

(b) Explain the problem that would occur if the two binary floating-point numbers representing the denary numbers 91.5 and 123.25 were added together and the result stored in the given system.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... [3]

6 **(a)** State **one** example of where sequential file organisation could be used.

.....

..... [1]

(b) Describe how records are organised in sequential files.

.....

.....

.....

..... [2]

(c) Outline the process of sequential file access to find a record in a sequential file.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... [3]

7 Data types can be defined using pseudocode.

The composite record data type, `Departure`, is used to represent flights from Cambridge Airport and is defined in pseudocode as:

```
TYPE Departure
   DECLARE FlightNumber : STRING
   DECLARE Destination : STRING
   DECLARE FlightDate : DATE
   DECLARE Gate : STRING
   DECLARE Airline : STRING
ENDTYPE
```

A variable, `Flight1`, is declared in pseudocode as:

```
DECLARE Flight1 : Departure
```

(a) Write **pseudocode** to store the following details to `Flight1`:

Field	Data
FlightNumber	SB2789
Destination	Dublin
FlightDate	30/07/2025
Gate	N03
Airline	Cambridge Airways

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... [3]

(b) The data type for `Gate` is changed to an enumerated data type, `GateID`.

(i) Write a **pseudocode** statement to declare `GateID` to hold the identity codes for the airport gates:

N01, N02, N03, W01, W02, W03, W04

.....

..... [2]

(ii) Write the new **pseudocode** statement required to replace the declaration of `Gate` in `Departure`.

8 Numbers are stored in a computer using binary floating-point representation with:

- 12 bits for the mantissa
- 4 bits for the exponent
- two's complement form for both the mantissa and the exponent.

(a) Calculate the normalised binary floating-point representation of +124.4375 in this system. Show your working.

Mantissa												Exponent			

Working .....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

[3]

(b) Calculate the denary value of the following normalised binary floating-point number. Show your working.

Mantissa												Exponent			
1	0	1	0	0	0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	1	1	0

Working .....

.....

.....

.....

.....

Denary value .....

[3]

9 **(a)** Random file organisation can be used with a database management system.

State **one** other example of where random file organisation could be used.

.....

..... [1]

(b) Describe how records are organised in random files.

.....

.....

.....

..... [2]

(c) Outline the process that would be used to find a record in a random file.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... [3]

10 Numbers are stored in a computer system using binary floating-point representation with:

- 10 bits for the mantissa
- 6 bits for the exponent
- two's complement form for both the mantissa and the exponent.

(a) Calculate the normalised binary floating-point representation of –10.8125 in this system.

Show your working.

mantissa										**exponent**					

working .....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

[3]

(b) Calculate the denary value of the given normalised binary floating-point number.

Show your working.

mantissa										**exponent**					
1	0	1	0	0	0	0	1	1	1	0	0	0	1	1	1

working .....

.....

.....

.....

.....

denary value .....

[3]

11 A programmer is writing a program to manage a video library. They require a user-defined data type.

(a) Write **pseudocode** statements to declare the composite data type `VideoLibrary` to hold data about each video in the collection. This data includes:

- identity code (any combination of letters and numbers)
- title
- year released
- date purchased
- format (for example DVD, Blu-ray, 4K, MP4)
- running time (minutes)

Use the most appropriate data type in each case.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

..... [4]

(b) Identify **one** field in `VideoLibrary` that could be an efficient enumerated data type and give a reason for your choice.

Field .....

.....

Reason .....

.....

[2]

12 Numbers are stored in a computer using binary floating-point representation with:

- 8 bits for the mantissa
- 8 bits for the exponent
- two's complement form for both the mantissa and the exponent.

(a) Give the largest normalised positive two's complement binary number that can be stored in this system **and** state its denary equivalent.

The denary answer should be expressed in terms of powers of 2.

Mantissa **Exponent**

Denary .....

[2]

(b) Calculate the normalised binary floating-point representation of –3.59375 in this system. Show your working.

Mantissa **Exponent**

Working .....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

[4]

END OF QUESTION PAPER

Source of each question (for marking)

Find the matching official Cambridge mark scheme for the series/paper shown, to mark your answers.

Q	Past paper	Original question	Marks
1	Oct/Nov 2025 Paper 31	Q1 (a),(b)	6
2	Oct/Nov 2025 Paper 31	Q2 (a),(b)	6
3	May/June 2026 Paper 33	Q1 (a),(b)	5
4	May/June 2026 Paper 33	Q3 (a),(b),(c)	6
5	May/June 2026 Paper 33	Q5 (a),(b)	7
6	May/June 2026 Paper 32	Q4 (a),(b),(c)	6
7	Oct/Nov 2025 Paper 32	Q1 (a),(b)	6
8	Oct/Nov 2025 Paper 32	Q2 (a),(b)	6
9	May/June 2026 Paper 31	Q2 (a),(b),(c)	6
10	May/June 2026 Paper 31	Q3 (a),(b)	6
11	Oct/Nov 2025 Paper 33	Q1 (a),(b)	6
12	Oct/Nov 2025 Paper 33	Q2 (a),(b)	6

Total: 72 marks